



Top 10 Lake District Dog Walks

www.thelakesincumbria.co.uk

The Lake District is a **fantastic** place for dog walks, with stunning scenery and plenty of trails to explore. Here are 10 of the best, offering a variety of landscapes and difficulties:

Top Dog-Friendly Walks

Here's a rundown of some of the best walks in the Lake District suitable for dogs, always ensuring to adhere to local guidelines and keep your dog under control:

- **Catbells:** A popular fell with rewarding views. The initial climb is steep, but manageable, and the panoramic views from the top are worth the effort. Keep dogs on a lead, especially near the summit.
- **Grasmere:** A gentle, scenic loop around the lake, perfect for a relaxed walk. There are plenty of opportunities for dogs to paddle in the water.
- **Derwentwater:** Another lovely lake walk, with options for extending the route. You can take a boat trip on the lake, some of which are dog-friendly.
- **Aira Force:** A spectacular waterfall with several walking trails through the surrounding woodland. Keep dogs on a lead near the waterfall and be mindful of the steep drops.
- **Borrowdale:** Explore the beautiful Borrowdale valley with its mix of woodland, riverside paths, and open fells. There are various trails to suit different abilities.
- **Buttermere:** A relatively easy, flat walk around the lake with stunning views of the surrounding fells. The path is mostly level and well-maintained.
- **Helvellyn via Striding Edge (for experienced dogs and owners):** A challenging but rewarding walk to the summit of Helvellyn. Striding Edge is a narrow ridge with steep drops, so only attempt this with a confident and well-behaved dog on a lead.
- **Tarn Hows:** A picturesque tarn with easy, accessible paths. The views are stunning, and it's a great spot for a picnic.
- **Grizedale Forest:** A large forest with numerous walking and cycling trails. There are plenty of sculptures to discover along the way, adding an extra element of interest.
- **Ullswater:** Explore the second largest lake in the Lake District with walks along the shoreline and into the surrounding fells.

Important Considerations

Before embarking on your Lake District adventure with your dog, keep the following in mind:

- **Keep dogs on leads:** Especially near livestock, on popular trails, and near cliff edges.
- **Be aware of wildlife:** The Lake District is home to a variety of wildlife, including sheep, birds, and red squirrels. Respect their habitat and avoid disturbing them.
- **Check the weather:** The weather in the Lake District can change quickly. Be prepared for all conditions and check the forecast before you set off.
- **Bring water and snacks:** Keep your dog hydrated and energized, especially on longer walks.
- **Clean up after your dog:** Always bag and dispose of dog waste responsibly. Leave no trace behind.
- **Parking:** Parking can be limited in some areas, especially during peak season. Arrive early or consider using public transport.
- **Path conditions:** Some paths can be rocky or uneven. Wear appropriate footwear and be prepared for varying terrain.

Enjoy your walks!

With its breathtaking scenery and numerous dog-friendly trails, the Lake District is the perfect destination for a walking holiday with your canine companion. Remember to plan ahead, be prepared, and most importantly, enjoy the stunning landscapes!